

Wenqing Zhang

✉ wzhan969@uwo.ca | 🏠 Personal Website | 🔗 LinkedIn

Education

-
- Western University** Sep 2025 – Present
- Master of Science in Computer Science
 - **GPA:** 92.5/100
- Shandong University** Sep 2021 – Jun 2025
- Bachelor of Engineering in Data Science and Big Data Technology
 - **GPA:** 91/100

Experience

-
- Research Assistant**, Department of Philosophy, Western University May 2026 – Present
Supervised by Dr. Alice Huang
- AI Integration in Group Decision-Making*
- Collaborating with Toronto's University Health Network on a study evaluating AI-assisted decision-making in transplant candidacy
 - Conducted the literature review and designed the study procedure and survey materials for the grant proposal
- Graduate Researcher**, Human-Centered Computing Group, Western University Sep 2025 – Present
Supervised by Dr. Umair Rehman
- Misalignment of Synthetic and Human Respondents*
- Compared LLM-generated and human responses to the Big Five personality inventory to assess whether LLMs can substitute for human participants
 - Conducted a five-level evaluation including means, distributions, reliability, inter-trait correlations, and behavioural comparison
- LLM Resilience to Misinformation in Multi-Turn Conversation*
- Proposed a framework in which a simulated user stress-tests the target model through persistent advocacy of a false claim
 - Identified distinct model behavioural patterns and found that models are most vulnerable to users who rely on emotional appeals to advocate for a false belief
- Impact of AI Chatbots on Human Beliefs*
- Designed an online experiment investigating whether LLMs can facilitate belief revision on normative topics
 - Prepared Research Ethics Board application materials for the study
- Teaching Assistant**, Western University Sep 2025 - Present
- Supervised students on the appropriate use of AI in assignments, exercise sessions and projects
 - Provided support on Python programming and game development
- Undergraduate Researcher**, Semantic Computing Lab, Shandong University Mar 2024 – May 2025
Supervised by Dr. Yuqing Sun
- LLM-based Psychological Scale Adaptation*
- Developed an LLM-based method that adapts existing scales into test items tailored to diverse respondent populations
 - Verified psychological construct alignment, respondent adaptation, and linguistic diversity of the generated items through automated metrics

Publications

Yuchen Han, **Wenqing Zhang**, and Yuqing Sun. (2026). From design to induction: A new paradigm for respondent-centric psychological scale generation. In *ICASSP 2026 – IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing* (pp. 18127–18131). IEEE.

Under Review

Wenqing Zhang, Haoran Wang, Arsh Chowdhry, and Umair Rehman. When Synthetic Users Look Human but Populations Do Not: A Calibrated Audit of LLM Stand-Ins for Human Participants. Submitted to the ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI).

In Preparation

Wenqing Zhang, Umair Rehman, and Apurva Narayan. The Fragility of Correction: Evaluating LLM Behaviour to Misinformation in Multi-Turn Dialogues.

Workshop and Conference Activities

Trainee in Science Communication , Communicating Science Conference Canada	Jun 2026
Poster Presentation , IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing 2026	May 2026
Oral Presentation , Western University Computer Science Departmental Conference	Apr 2026

Memberships

Vice President , The Human Factors and Ergonomics Society Student Chapter	May 2026 – Present
• Co-founded the student chapter	
Student Member , Rotman Institute of Philosophy	Apr 2026 – Present
• Participated in the philosophy of reinforcement learning reading group • Participated in workshops on cross-disciplinary collaboration • Contributing to the Rotman-Mitacs Not-for-Profit Research Initiative, seeking research collaborations with non-profit organizations	

Honors and Awards

Best Presentation , Western University Computer Science Departmental Conference	Apr 2026
Silver Medal , Kaggle Credit Risk Prediction Competition (92nd of 3,856 teams)	May 2024
Second-Class Scholarship (Top 15%)	2022 – 2023, 2023 – 2024
First-Class Scholarship (Top 5%)	2021 – 2022